

be controlled via Android or iOS smartphones once the two are connected via Bluetooth. The product from Orbotix includes multi-colored LEDs, a polycarbonate shell and a roll speed of seven feet per second. Users can program Sphero using 'MacroLab', a GUI-programming app meant to introduce beginners to programming. The app is available for download on leading mobile platforms. The ball can be programmed to perform various tasks ranging in complexity. Some of the simpler tasks are rolling along, line following, racing with other Spheros and so on. One of its advanced features is its



ability to act as an external marker in augmented reality (AR) vision – apparently the first time a robot is being used in this way. The company released an AR game to supplement Sphero called 'Sharky the Beaver', where users control a beaver on a screen by means of the sphere as an external marker. The company has also released the SDK for the toy's software so that users could make their own apps to be used with it. This is how there are over 25 apps in the Google Play Store made by its users.

Sphero: <http://www.gosphero.com/>

4.Sam Blocks

The latest tech toy making the news these days is the 'SAM' set of building blocks, based on wireless connectivity. It's also used as a prototype for companies developing for the Internet of Things.

SAM is the brainchild of Joachim Horn, who got fed up of using a multitude of wires every time he needed to make an electrical circuit. This led him to the idea of connecting two or more components wirelessly. Soon, he